ANSWER KEY

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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION March 2026

Fourth SEMESTER

Value Addition Course (VAC) - MG4VACPOL200 - LEGAL LITERACY AND LEGAL AWARENESS

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

PART A

1. b). Use of precedents and equity jurisprudence

2. b) ADR strengthens access to justice under Article 21/d). ADR ensures speedy trials

3. c) Local Self Government Institution

4. c) 30 Days

5. c) Financial emergencies

6. c) Article 21 read with Article 39A

7. b) 1986

8. a) 2000

9. d) U.S. Constitution

10. d) Enforcement of fundamental rights

PART B

11. Protective discrimination policies–constitutional commitment to social justice–upliftment of marginalized communities–reservation in legislatures, Parliament–reserved seats in Lok Sabha, state assemblies–political representation guarantees reservation in public employment-affirmative action in government services–equal opportunity provisions– reservation in educational institutions–access to higher education opportunities–scholarships and welfare schemes–special provisions under Articles 15(4) 16(4)–Article 46 directive principles–promotion of educational economic interests–National Commission for Scheduled Castes–National Commission for Scheduled Tribes–constitutional monitoring mechanisms–protection from social discrimination–legal safeguards against untouchability–SC ST Prevention of Atrocities Act.

12. Economically weaker sections- eligibility–low income threshold- criteria–financial inability to hire lawyer–members of Scheduled Castes Scheduled Tribes–legal assistance entitlement–social justice principle–women and children- eligible–victims of trafficking exploitation–vulnerable groups protection–persons with disabilities mental illness–victims of natural disasters–industrial workmen eligibility–people in custody prisoners detainees–

juveniles in conflict with law–Legal Services Authorities Act- provisions–state sponsored legal representation–access to justice initiatives.

13.Judicial doctrine evolved by Supreme Court–limitation on parliament's amending power–essential features of constitution protected–cannot be altered or destroyed– origin in *Kesavananda Bharati case*–landmark constitutional judgment 1973– principles like supremacy of constitution–rule of law separation of powers– independence of judiciary–federalism democratic structure– judicial review parliamentary system–protection of fundamental rights–ensuring constitutional identity stability–balance between amendment and preservation.

14.Minimum wage- legally mandated wage–fixed by government authority–ensures basic subsistence income– applies to specific scheduled employment–varies across sectors regions–floor wage-nationally determined baseline–central government sets minimum benchmark–states cannot fix wages below floor wage–ensures national wage protection– objective reducing wage exploitation–promoting fair labour standards– difference in scope and authority–sector specific versus national baseline– support for workers' welfare–minimum income security guarantee.

15.National Commission for Protection of Child Rights–statutory body safeguarding child interests– state commissions for child rights–monitoring child welfare implementation–child welfare committees–care protection for vulnerable children– juvenile justice boards–handling cases involving children– UNICEF international child rights advocacy–policy guidance support– National Human Rights Commission involvement–monitoring child rights violations– government ministries women and child development–implementation of child protection schemes– civil society organizations NGOs–awareness campaigns child welfare initiatives.

16.Right to safety–protection from hazardous goods services–consumer welfare assurance–right to be informed–accurate information about quality price standards– right to choose–access to variety of goods services–competitive markets– right to be heard–consumer interests considered in forums–complaint mechanisms– right to seek redressal–compensation for defective goods services–legal remedy provisions– right to consumer education–awareness of consumer rights responsibilities– strengthening fair trade practices–consumer protection councils and authorities.

17.Branch of law- governing constitution–framework of political authority– rules defining powers of government–structure of state institutions– distribution of powers among organs–legislature executive judiciary– relationship between state and citizens–protection of fundamental rights– principles guiding governance administration–constitutional supremacy concept– legal limits on government power–ensuring rule of law– foundation of democratic governance–interpretation by constitutional courts.

18.Clean drinking water facilities–adequate sanitation arrangements–separate toilets for men women–washing bathing facilities for workers–hygienic workplace conditions– canteen

facilities in large establishments–nutritious food provision– rest rooms shelters seating arrangements–comfort during working hours– first aid boxes medical facilities–occupational health services– crèche facilities for working mothers–child care support provisions– welfare officers in large establishments–monitoring labour welfare standards.

PART C

19. Power of judiciary to review–constitutional supremacy principle–checks legislative executive actions–ensuring conformity with constitution–protection of fundamental rights–judicial interpretation authority–origin in Articles 13, 32, 226–courts empowered to invalidate unconstitutional laws–Supreme Court-guardian of constitution–High Courts supervisory jurisdiction–review of constitutional amendments–basic structure doctrine limitation–judicial control over administrative decisions–preventing misuse of power–ensuring rule of law–maintaining balance among organs of government–strengthening democratic accountability–citizen protection against arbitrary state action.

20. Law emerging from customs, traditions–primitive societies governed by customs–community based dispute resolution–religious influence on early legal systems–divine law, moral codes–ancient civilizations- legal codes–Hammurabi code- Roman law–development of natural law theory–justice morality foundations–rise of positive law theory–law as command of sovereign–growth of common law system–precedents judicial decisions–modern constitutional law development–codified statutes democratic governance–international law evolution–global legal norms human rights framework.

21. Constitutional guarantees of equality–Articles 14, 15, 16–protection against discrimination–special provisions for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes–affirmative action policies–Directive Principles- promoting social justice–Article 46- welfare focus–protection of minorities, women, children–legal safeguards frameworks–laws like SC ST Prevention of Atrocities Act–Domestic Violence Act–child protection laws- juvenile justice framework–rights of persons with disabilities–National Human Rights Commission monitoring–National Commissions for women, minorities–government welfare schemes social security programs–egal aid access to justice.

22. Consolidation of labour laws reforms–part of labour codes 2020–simplifying industrial relations framework–recognition of trade unions rights–registration and representation procedures–collective bargaining mechanisms–negotiating union concept–rules governing strikes, lockouts–notice requirements, dispute resolution–industrial tribunals for adjudication–speedy settlement of disputes–layoff retrenchment, closure provisions–worker protection safeguards–balance between employer flexibility–workers job security–objective- promoting industrial peace–productivity economic growth labour welfare.